

ReferralMe Review Report

Current Position, What To Keep, What To Remove, What To Build Next

1. Executive Summary

After reviewing the current ReferralMe product, the Campus Ambassador system, and the external report you received, the clearest conclusion is:

ReferralMe should not be built as a pure paid referral marketplace.

That path is risky, weak in trust, hard to scale, and has already failed many times in other markets.

ReferralMe should instead become a career outcomes platform, where:

- referrals are the hook
- but the real value is a package around job success

That means the platform should help users with:

- opportunities
- referral access
- ATS and resume improvement
- mentoring
- interview preparation
- job momentum

So the product should move from:

"Get a referral"

to:

"Get closer to a real job outcome."

That is the strongest direction.

2. Present State of ReferralMe

Right now, ReferralMe already has useful building blocks:

What already exists

- seeker and referrer structure
- referral-based thinking

- ATS resume scan
- opportunity and job flow
- dashboard flows
- campus ambassador program
- admin controls
- announcements and email workflows
- profile and upload system

This is a strong foundation.

Current strength

The product already feels like more than a simple referral idea. It has the base to become a broader student and early-career platform.

Current weakness

The overall product story is still not sharp enough.

A new user may still ask:

- Is this a referral platform?
- Is this a job board?
- Is this a mentorship platform?
- Is this for students?
- Is this for professionals?
- What is the main reason to use it?

That confusion is the main thing to fix now.

3. Main Strategic Conclusion

What ReferralMe should become

ReferralMe should become a career acceleration platform for students and early professionals.

What referrals should be

Referrals should remain the wedge, not the whole business.

That means:

- referrals bring users in
- ATS and resume help make the product more useful
- mentoring adds more value
- campus ambassadors become the growth engine

- later we can add more layers step by step

This is the strongest model.

4. What To Keep

These should stay and become stronger.

1. ReferralMe brand

Do not rush to change the name right now.

Reason:

- the brand still fits if referrals remain the core entry point
- changing too early creates confusion
- the problem is not mainly the brand name, it is the product framing

2. ATS and resume improvement

This is one of the strongest features to keep.

Reason:

- high user value
- easy to understand
- repeatable
- supports job outcomes directly

3. Campus Ambassador program

Keep it.

Reason:

- this can become your low-cost growth engine
- it gives you community, identity, and student distribution
- this is one of your strongest differentiators

4. Opportunities, jobs, internships

Keep this as a major pillar.

Reason:

- users need visible job outcomes
- without opportunities, the platform feels incomplete

5. Referral request layer

Keep this, but change how it is framed.

Reason:

- it is still valuable
- but it should not feel like "buy referral access"

6. Email, announcement, engagement layer

Keep and expand.

Reason:

- this helps retention
- this helps weekly engagement
- this helps campus and seeker activation

5. What To Change

These things should be repositioned, not necessarily removed.

1. Change the product messaging

Current risk:

- it may feel too referral-only

New direction:

- make it clear ReferralMe is about getting hired faster and better
- not just asking strangers for referrals

2. Change the pricing and value framing

Do not sell:

- pay for referral

Instead sell:

- career consultation
- resume improvement
- mock interview
- mentorship

- job acceleration package
- referral guidance or referral access as part of the bundle

This is safer and stronger.

3. Change the homepage positioning

The main page should explain clearly that ReferralMe helps users with:

- job opportunities
- referrals
- resume readiness
- career support
- campus growth

Not just referrals.

6. What To Add

These are the best additions after reviewing the report.

Priority 1: Career outcomes layer

Add these first:

A. Mentoring and career consultation

- 1:1 guidance
- role and company-specific advice
- application strategy

Why:

- increases trust
- increases monetization potential
- turns ReferralMe into a stronger product

B. Resume review

- not just ATS score
- actual resume feedback
- improvement recommendations

Why:

- users understand this immediately
- highly useful

- easy attach service

C. Mock interviews

- technical
- HR
- behavioral
- role-specific

Why:

- strong value
- fits job outcome narrative
- repeatable

Priority 2: Better seeker momentum

D. Personalized opportunity dashboard

- recommended jobs
- referral-friendly roles
- saved opportunities
- activity history

E. Weekly career digest

- jobs
- reminders
- ATS prompts
- profile tips
- new product updates

F. Profile strength and readiness score

- profile completion
- resume quality
- LinkedIn
- interview readiness

This makes the platform feel alive.

Priority 3: Stronger growth features

G. College leaderboard

H. Referral count

I. Shareable ambassador badge

J. Top performer and top college visibility

These make the campus program much stronger.

7. What To Delete or Deprioritize

Not everything should be built now.

1. Pure paid referral marketplace idea

This should be dropped as the main model.

Do not make the company story:

- pay and get referred

This is the biggest thing to avoid.

2. Too many random verticals at once

Avoid loading:

- courses
- community
- placement prep
- freelancing
- mentorship marketplace
- bootcamp
- creator economy
- all at once

This will reduce clarity.

3. Low-trust referrer marketplace model

Avoid turning it into:

- anyone lists themselves
- candidates pay them directly for referral promises

That is risky for:

- trust
- compliance
- brand
- long-term reputation

4. Overbuilding admin-heavy features first

Do not spend too much time adding large operational tools if user value is still the main problem.

Focus first on:

- user value
- conversion
- retention
- monetizable outcomes

8. Best Recommended MVP Now

ReferralMe MVP 2.0

A strong next MVP should be:

Core

- jobs, internships, opportunities
- referral request flow
- ATS resume scan
- seeker dashboard

Career outcomes

- resume review
- mock interview
- mentoring or consultation

Growth engine

- campus ambassador program
- announcements
- weekly emails
- leaderboard and social proof

That is a real product.

It is much stronger than a referral-only platform, and still focused enough to execute.

9. Recommended New Positioning

Use language like this:

Positioning line

ReferralMe helps students and early professionals get closer to jobs through referrals, readiness, and career support.

Simple version

ReferralMe is a career acceleration platform, not just a referral tool.

Campus version

Campus Ambassador helps ReferralMe grow through student leaders, visibility, and career community building.

10. Recommended User Segments

Primary for growth

- students
- final-year students
- recent graduates
- early-career job seekers

Primary for monetization later

- mid-career professionals
- job switchers
- professionals willing to pay for better outcomes

This is important:

- students can be the growth engine
- mid-career can become the stronger paid layer later

You do not need to choose only one forever, but right now your product and campus system already give you an advantage on the student side.

11. Final Recommendation

Clear recommendation

1. Keep the name ReferralMe
2. Do not build a pure paid referral marketplace
3. Reposition the platform as a career outcomes product
4. Keep referrals as the hook
5. Add mentoring, mock interviews, and resume review
6. Use campus ambassadors as the growth engine
7. Expand step by step, not all at once

12. Final One-Line Summary

ReferralMe should evolve into a student and early-career job acceleration platform, where referrals are the entry point, but the real product is career outcomes.